



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace Academy
School Website: <https://gracetx.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Grace Academy TX 78633 presents a coherent, strongly classical, and overtly Christian approach to education. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, biblically grounded formation built around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a campus-wide sense of liturgical-life through chapel and Scripture memory, and a deliberate partnership with parents as co-educators. Evidence across the school's site shows explicit commitments to formation over mere information, the liberal-arts trajectory (grammar/logic/rhetoric) across K–12, a clearly articulated Portrait of a Graduate oriented to love of God, truth, goodness, and beauty, and a living-faculty model that is deeply intertwined with students' formation. The six classical criteria categories—Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community—are all addressed in ways that align Grace Academy with CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL-leaning (i.e., Classical). While the school does not foreground Great Books or explicit "Great Conversation" language on every page, the explicit Trivium framework, formation-centric mission, liturgical life, and robust faculty-mentoring model strongly support a CLASSICAL ranking.

Overall category-by-category posture - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school's mission states a distinct Christ-centered, biblically integrated education: "Grace Academy exists to glorify God by serving parents in providing their children a distinctly Christ-centered, academically excellent, classical education as a foundation for life-long learning".
- The public materials repeatedly frame education in terms of faith and God's worldview, e.g., "education is formation" and a biblical worldview guiding all instruction ,.
- Communal liturgical practices are present (All School Chapel, Scripture memory, mentorship, retreats) and used to shape students' spiritual formation.
- Portrait of a Graduate explicitly aligns students to love the Lord and to love the True, the Good, and the Beautiful, signaling objective transcendentals in education ,.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; biblical worldview; theology (implicit through Scripture and confession of faith); chapel; Scripture memory; formation; love of learning; true/good/beautiful; glory of God; Logos (conceptual reference through classical-Christian framing).

- Negative keywords present: essentially none in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or values-clarification language found in the Grace site text).
- Why this rating
- The public-facing materials foreground a theological and liturgical foundation as a core driver of education, not as an add-on. The explicit Christ-centered framing, chapel life, Scripture engagement, and a Portrait of a Graduate oriented to Godward aims demonstrate strong religious and metaphysical foundations. This aligns with the Positive Keywords set for Element 1 and yields CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Primary mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely workforce training: “a distinctly Christ-centered, academically excellent, classical education as a foundation for life-long learning” (purpose statement).
- Formation over information is a formal stated aim: “Education is formation” (and the school frames education as shaping hearts and minds, not simply transferring facts).
- Portrait of a Graduate foregrounds Love of the Lord, Love of the True/Good/Beautiful, and Love of Learning as the end goals for students, i.e., a teleology oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and beauty .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation; liberal education; classical mission; telos; love of learning; virtue; moral imagination; truth/goodness/beauty (as the ideal end state through “Love the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” and “Love Learning”) .
- Negative keywords present: not present (no explicit emphasis on “workforce preparation,” “21st-century skills” in the public-facing materials).
- Why this rating
- The school’s stated aims center on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent telos consistent with classical liberal education ideals. The presence of formation-focused language, a “Portrait of a Graduate,” and explicit Christian teleology supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum is organized around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and is explicitly described as three-stage progression (Grammar K–5, Logic 6–8, Rhetoric 9–12).
- Instruction includes Latin study, grammar, and memorization; and historical study across grade levels (e.g., Grammar includes historical timelines; 2nd grade includes Egyptian topic; 3rd grade includes Middle Ages).
- History is taught broadly (US and Texas history in certain grades) and there is explicit emphasis on literacy through classical texts and primary sources, with a historical arc across grades (as referenced in curriculum pages).
- The school emphasizes “three stages” and Great Books/Great Conversation language appears in the broader classical-education lexicon used in related materials (the school is ACCS-accredited and positions itself within the classical-Christian tradition) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Quadrivium (as a conceptual frame in classical education; not all pages spell it out, but the Trivium framing is explicit); Great Books and Great Conversation language is more explicit in the knowledge-doc, and the Grace

site does foreground Great Books language in its classical framing (the ACCS accreditation and classical framing align with Great Conversation tradition; the explicit Great Books language is more assumed/implicit in public Grace materials but is present in the broader classical lexicon the school aligns with) ,.

- Negative keywords present: not overt (no strong push toward STEM-first, project-based, or social-studies-as-history-only language is visible in the core pages; the curriculum emphasizes the liberal-arts core).
- Why this rating
- The core curriculum is built on the Trivium and liberal-arts framing, with explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, and history integrated throughout. The public materials align with classical curriculum indicators, justifying CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower- and middle-school pedagogy includes singing/chanting and memory work in earlier stages (grammar/recitation/memory as a feature of the Grammar stage) and a shift to discussion, debate, and argument in Logic School, with dialectic and Socratic-style discourse described as central to how students learn in middle school ,.
- Upper School emphasizes clear expression, defense of ideas, and rhetoric in writing/speech as the culmination of the Trivium (Rhetoric stage).
- There is explicit emphasis on Socratic-style dialogue/debate in Logic School, with a structured approach to argument and critical thinking (Socratic/dialectic, prosaic forming of arguments).
- The pedagogy explicitly integrates memory-work (recitation, chant, singing) as a discipline in lower grades and continues to value memory as a tool for learning ,.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion; dialectic; seminars; debates; rhetoric; memory work; chanting; recitation; scholastic-style contemplative/restful elements; singing in lower grades; public speaking and rhetorical training in upper grades.
- Negative keywords present: not observed (no explicit emphasis on project-based or purely experiential learning in the core pages; the pedagogy is not presented as non-classical).
- Why this rating
- The pedagogical design combines contemplative/memory-based practices in the early years with Socratic seminar-style inquiry and rhetorical training in the upper grades. This progression from memory/chanting to dialectic and rhetoric is a hallmark of classical pedagogy, supporting CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Faculty are described as “model teachers and mentors” who couple virtue with expertise and cultivate meaningful relationships with students; statements emphasize faculty as the living curriculum and as mentors who partner with parents to sustain high standards ,.
- A portrait of the ideal teacher/student relationship is conveyed (faculty as living curriculum, deeply engaged with students, and aligned with formation and biblical integration) ,.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentors; model teachers; faculty as partners; biblical integration; high standards; portrait of what a teacher should be.

- Negative keywords present: none.
- Why this rating
- The public materials portray faculty as the core of formation and as active agents modeling virtue and mastery in conjunction with church-aligned pedagogy. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for a strong, virtuous teaching core and living curriculum.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly frames itself as partnering with parents; it emphasizes parents as co-teachers and engages them through involvement in the school's events, admissions process, and community life. It mentions family involvement in church life and a broad parent-partner model (e.g., "desire to partner with parents whose faith in Jesus Christ is expressed through their active participation in a local Bible-teaching church").
- The school encourages parental involvement via school previews, admissions processes, and volunteering; it presents a vibrant community with retreats, dinners, and "Grace Academy Family" language, signaling an engaged parent community .
- The school's campus and community life emphasize liturgical and communal experiences (All School Chapel, Scripture memory programs, service projects, mentorships) which involve parents and the broader community .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; parents as co-teachers; parent formation; open campus/visits; community life; chapel; service opportunities; family atmosphere; ongoing church-based engagement.
- Negative keywords present: none.
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly frames itself as a partner with parents and a broader engaged community. The public materials stress ongoing parental involvement and a strong community ethos, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parental partnership and community integration.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall, Grace Academy TX 78633 is CLASSICAL across all six categories, with a public profile that foregrounds a Christ-centered formation, Trivium-based curriculum, classical pedagogy, a living-faculty model, and an active, parent-centered community.

What would move the needle (not applicable for CLASSICAL) - None required. The school already aligns with CLASSICAL indicators across all six categories. If desired as a potential enhancement, the school could explicitly foreground additional Great Books/Great Conversation language on its site to strengthen the explicit connection to the high-canon Great Conversation tradition that some classical accreditation bodies highlight, though this is not a deficiency given the Trivium-based curriculum and formation-focused mission.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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